



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 8

PART 1

You will hear a conversation between a receptionist and a customer who wants to book a photography workshop. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker A: Hello, Community Education Center, how can I help you?

Speaker B: Hi, I'd like to enroll in the intermediate photography course that's coming up.

Speaker A: Sure, let me get the booking form up on my screen. First, what is your full name?

Speaker B: It's Peter Gilmour.

Speaker A: Could you spell your last name for me, please?

Speaker B: Yes, it's G-I-L-M-O-U-R.

Speaker A: Got it, thank you. And which level of the course are you looking to join? We have beginner, intermediate, and advanced.

Speaker B: Well, I already know the basics, so I want to join the intermediate course.

Speaker A: Perfect. Let me check the schedule for that. The course was originally scheduled to begin on the 12th of October... oh, wait, let me check the tutor's calendar again. Ah, yes, she had a conflict on that Friday. The actual start date is the 13th of October. Is that okay for you?

Speaker B: Yes, Saturday the 13th of October is actually much better for me.

Speaker A: Excellent. The classes will be held weekly in Studio 3, which is on the second floor.

Speaker B: Great, Studio 3. I will write that down.

Speaker A: Next, I need a contact number for you in case there are any last-minute schedule changes.

Speaker B: Sure, it's 0-7-9-4-1-8-2-0-3-5-6.

Speaker A: Let me read that back to make sure I got it right: 0-7-9-4-1-8-2-0-3-5-6. Is that correct?

Speaker B: Yes, that is correct.

Speaker A: Great. Now, do you have a membership with our community center? If so, you should have a reference code.

Speaker B: Yes, I do. Let me look it up... here it is. The code is 9-4-2-0-7.

Speaker A: Let me input that: 9-4-2-0-7. Yes, your membership details have popped up on my screen.

Speaker B: Excellent. And how much is the fee for the course?

Speaker A: The standard fee is 65 pounds... oh, wait, sorry, let me look at your membership discount details... Ah, since you have an active membership, it is actually 45 pounds.

Speaker B: That's a nice surprise. I'll pay the 45 pounds by credit card now, if that's alright?

Speaker A: Yes, of course. I'll process that in a moment. Just a quick reminder about what you need to bring to the class. You don't need to bring any extra lighting gear, but you must bring a tripod. The center doesn't have enough of those to supply to everyone.

Speaker B: That's fine, I have a sturdy tripod, so I'll bring that along. I actually heard about this course from a poster. I saw it when I visited the local library last week.

Speaker A: Ah, the library poster! We only put that up ten days ago. It's great to hear that people are noticing it.

Speaker B: Yes, it really caught my eye. Oh, and is there parking available at the center?

Speaker A: Yes, we have an on-site car park. You can park there for free, but you must display a valid permit on your dashboard. I can email you one to print out.

Speaker B: That would be extremely helpful. Thank you so much!

Speaker A: No problem at all. I've sent the booking confirmation and your permit to your email address.

This is the end of Part 1.

PART 2

You will hear a talk by a local heritage officer about the history and development of Oakridge Community Park. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening, everyone. It's wonderful to see so many local residents here tonight to learn more about the history and development of Oakridge Community Park. As the local heritage officer, I've spent the last three years researching the park's fascinating past, and I'm delighted to share some of our findings with you today.

Speaker A: First, let's talk about how the park came to be. Many people assume it was created to protect the ancient woodland, but that's actually a modern priority. The park wasn't originally created as a public space at all. Back in 1875, a wealthy industrialist named Thomas Vance purchased the land. He wanted to establish a private garden for his family estate, complete with exotic plants and ornamental lakes. The local community wasn't allowed inside for decades, until the local council finally purchased the land in the 1920s and opened it to everyone.

Speaker A: One of our most popular attractions today is the tea room. There is a common rumor that it is run by local volunteers, but it is actually operated by professional caterers to ensure high-quality service. It's a wonderful place to stop, and it is situated in the former greenhouse, which was beautifully restored to preserve its original Victorian glasswork.

Speaker A: If you venture past the tea room, you will find our beautiful ancient woodland. In addition to the towering oak trees, visitors love looking at the collection of wooden sculptures. These were carved directly from fallen trees by a local artist and represent different forest animals. We had hoped to build a bird hide there this spring, but due to budget constraints, that project has been put on hold for now.

Speaker A: For those of you who visit with pets, we want to maintain a safe environment. Dogs do not have to be kept on a lead at all times, and they are free to run in the open fields. However, dogs are not permitted near the children's play area under any circumstances, and signs have been posted to remind owners of this rule.

Speaker A: Finally, I want to mention our upcoming events. This coming Saturday, the park will host an outdoor craft market. Over thirty local artisans will be selling handmade goods, so please come along and support them. It's going to be a lively day, and the live music concert we have scheduled will take place next month, so don't miss this weekend's market!

Speaker A: Now, let's look at how you can get involved. We rely heavily on volunteers to keep the park looking its best. Currently, we are looking for volunteers to help with maintenance. In particular, we need people to help repair the historic wood and stone

fences that run along the boundary of the rose garden.

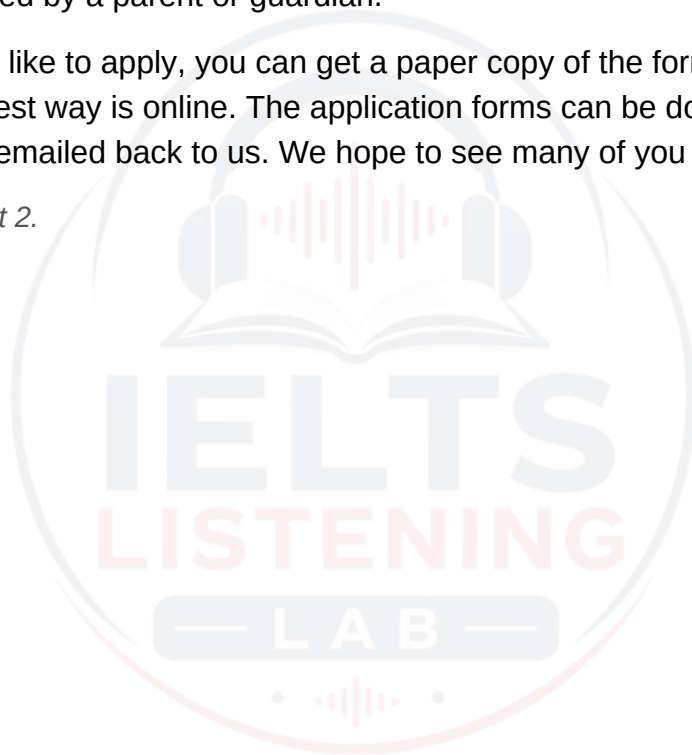
Speaker A: Volunteering is hard work, but we make sure our helpers are well looked after. To show our appreciation, all volunteers will receive free lunch at the tea room during their shifts, as well as unlimited hot drinks.

Speaker A: If you're interested in joining us, safety is our top priority. The ground can be very uneven, so it is essential to wear sturdy boots for all outdoor work. We cannot allow anyone to work in trainers or light shoes.

Speaker A: In terms of eligibility, we welcome helpers of all backgrounds. However, please note that the minimum age for solo volunteers is eighteen. Anyone under that age must be accompanied by a parent or guardian.

Speaker A: If you'd like to apply, you can get a paper copy of the form from the visitor center, but the easiest way is online. The application forms can be downloaded from the park's website and emailed back to us. We hope to see many of you there!

This is the end of Part 2.



PART 3

You will hear two university students, Chloe and Emily, discussing their research project on vertical farming with their tutor, Dr. Sarah. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker A: Hello Chloe, Emily. Come on in and take a seat. How is your research project on vertical farming coming along?

Speaker B: Well, Dr. Sarah, we've done a lot of reading, but we're struggling a bit to narrow down our focus. There is just so much information out there.

Speaker C: Yes, it's a massive topic. But we've found some really interesting data.

Speaker A: That's completely normal at this stage. What has stood out to you most in your initial reading?

Speaker B: For me, I was reading about how vertical farming uses up to ninety-five percent less water than traditional open-field agriculture. I knew it was efficient, but that percentage really shocked me. It's amazing how much is saved.

Speaker C: Yes, that is remarkable. Although the high setup costs are huge, I already expected that because of the technology involved.

Speaker A: Yes, the water efficiency is indeed a major breakthrough. Now, have you decided which aspects of vertical farming you will focus on in your actual presentation?

Speaker C: We initially thought about looking at whether the crops are more nutritious than soil-grown ones. However, we quickly realized that the biochemistry involved is just too complex for a ten-minute presentation. We'd get bogged down in technical details.

Speaker B: I agree. Even though there is plenty of reliable research out there, we would spend the whole time explaining plant nutrients instead of the farming systems themselves.

Speaker A: That's a very wise decision. It's always better to keep your presentation focused on broader environmental and economic impacts. Now, what about your primary research? Have you started your public survey yet?

Speaker B: We have written the draft questions, and we were planning to send them out online this afternoon.

Speaker A: Hold on a moment. Before you distribute it to the general public, you really need to pilot the survey with a small group of your classmates. That way, you can see if any of your questions are confusing or need to be rephrased before you collect real data.

Speaker C: That makes sense. We'll ask a few classmates to try it out tomorrow.

Speaker A: Excellent. And what about your case study?

Speaker C: I'm a bit worried about the case study we chose—the commercial vertical farm in Singapore. It's incredibly high-tech and heavily subsidized by the government, which makes it quite atypical compared to standard commercial farms in other parts of the world.

Speaker B: That's true, Emily, but it does have excellent financial data from last year, which is very up-to-date and useful for our analysis.

Speaker A: Emily has a valid point, but it's still a valuable example as long as you highlight those unique government subsidies in your slides. It shows what is possible with state backing.

Speaker B: Okay, we will keep it then. So, what should we work on next?

Speaker C: Well, we can't analyze the survey results yet, and we shouldn't start designing our slides until the actual content is locked.

Speaker B: Right, so let's write the introduction first. That will give our project a clear structure and help us write the rest of the sections.

Speaker A: That is a very logical next step. Now, let's talk about the specific agricultural technologies you'll cover in your technical section. How are you dividing them?

Speaker B: Well, first we have Hydroponics. The major benefit of this system is that it allows easy chemical control. Because there's no soil to interfere, farmers can easily manage and adjust the chemical nutrients in the liquid solution to perfectly match the plants' needs.

Speaker C: Next is Aeroponics, where plants are suspended in the air and their roots are misted with nutrient water. This method results in much faster plant growth because the roots get maximum oxygen exposure, speeding up their metabolic rate.

Speaker B: Then we'll look at Aquaponics, which combines fish farming with plant cultivation in a closed loop. Since the fish waste provides natural nutrients for the plants, the system requires very low energy consumption compared to active mechanical systems that require constant pump filtering.

Speaker C: We also need to talk about LED lighting systems. By stacking shelves vertically under these energy-efficient lights, you get incredibly high space efficiency, producing more food per square meter than almost any other farming method.

Speaker B: Finally, we'll cover automated harvesting. The primary benefit of using robotic arms and conveyor belts for this is the dramatically reduced labor costs, which helps make



the vertical farm much more profitable in the long run.

Speaker A: This sounds like a very comprehensive overview. You've done some excellent preparation, girls.

This is the end of Part 3.



PART 4

You will hear a lecture about the history and preservation of ancient shipwrecks in the Baltic Sea. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Good morning, class. Today, we're going to explore a unique archaeological treasury... the Baltic Sea. Unlike most of the world's oceans, which quickly destroy historical artifacts, the Baltic Sea preserves them. In fact, it is home to an estimated one hundred thousand shipwrecks, many of which are completely intact.

Speaker A: The primary reason for this extraordinary preservation lies in the unique environment of the Baltic. First, we must look at the wood. In warmer, saltier waters, wooden hulls are quickly destroyed. However, the Baltic Sea is semi-enclosed, meaning it has a very low level of salt. This brackish water makes it highly inhospitable to many marine organisms that usually consume organic material.

Speaker A: Most importantly, the Baltic lacks a destructive organism known as the shipworm. This wood-boring bivalve mollusk is responsible for the rapid destruction of shipwrecks in other parts of the world. It cannot survive in the Baltic, not only because of the low salinity but also due to the extremely cold temperatures of the water year-round.

Speaker A: Furthermore, the deep waters of the Baltic have very low levels of oxygen. Without sufficient oxygen, the bacteria that normally cause wood to rot cannot thrive. As a result, ships made of wood can remain almost perfectly preserved at the bottom of the sea for hundreds, or even thousands, of years.

Speaker A: A prime example of this preservation is the famous Swedish warship, the Vasa. Built to be the pride of the Swedish Navy, the Vasa tragically sank in the year 1628, just minutes into its maiden voyage, in full view of a horrified crowd.

Speaker A: The disaster occurred because the ship was poorly designed. The king had demanded extra guns, making the vessel far too heavy at the top. When a sudden gust of wind hit the sails, the ship tilted, water poured into the open gun ports, and it sank immediately.

Speaker A: When the Vasa was finally salvaged in 1961, it was virtually intact. However, once exposed to the air, the water-logged wood began to dry out and shrink, which threatened to destroy the ship. To prevent this, archaeologists spent years spraying the hull with a specialized wax, which slowly replaced the water inside the wood fibers and stabilized the structure. Today, it stands as a spectacular exhibit in Stockholm.

Speaker A: Unfortunately, these ancient wrecks are now facing new, modern threats. Firstly, technology has advanced rapidly. The widespread availability of side-scan sonar

has made it incredibly easy for commercial divers to locate deep wrecks that were once hidden. This has led to concerns about looting and accidental damage.

Speaker A: Secondly, climate change poses a major environmental threat. As ocean temperatures rise, the water is becoming warmer and saltier. This environmental shift is allowing the destructive shipworm to slowly migrate and spread into parts of the Baltic Sea where it was previously unable to survive, putting thousands of untouched wooden wrecks at risk.

Speaker A: In response, regional governments are taking action. They are using advanced satellite monitoring to track illegal diving activity, and they have introduced strict new laws to restrict access to valuable archaeological sites. It is hoped that these measures will preserve this underwater museum for future generations.

This is the end of Part 4.

